FOR A SALES HIRE EVALUATING FRESHA · SALES ROLE · 2026-05-29

Fresha — A Walking-In Briefing

Eight days ago Fresha became a unicorn. Here is what you need to know walking in — calibrated honestly, not flattered.

$1B+ VALUATION · MAY 21 2026	**$80M** KKR GROWTH ROUND	**140K+** BUSINESSES	**500K+** PROFESSIONALS
35M MONTHLY BOOKINGS	**$15B** ANNUAL GMV	**757** EMPLOYEES	**15 / 120** OFFICES / COUNTRIES

▸ WHAT THIS IS, WHAT IT ISN'T

It is: a one-shot orientation doc for a sales hire walking into Fresha — what the company is, how the model works, who you're fighting, what the floor feels like, what to ask before you sign.

It is not: a recommendation to take or leave the job, a negotiation playbook, or an attempt to flatter or trash Fresha. Every hard claim carries a credibility tier T1 – T5 so you can see what's load-bearing.

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01 TL;DR — seven things to know 4 MIN READ

If you read nothing else, read this. Each line is unpacked later.

1. **Fresha is the "Booking.com of salons."** London-HQ, Dubai-founded as *Shedul* in Feb 2015 T2 , rebranded 2020 T2 , hit unicorn 8 days ago with an $80M KKR round at $1B+ T2 . First institutional growth equity since Dec 2021. *This is a real company at a real inflection.*

2. **The model is not classic per-seat SaaS.** It's *free-software-historically + payments-attach + marketplace commission*. Then in **March 2025 they introduced a paid tier** T1 and operators were loud about it T5. The pricing-change wound is still open. Lead conversations with empathy on it, not denial.

3. **Three wedges, in order:** free signup → Fresha Pay (no-show protection is the conversion event) → marketplace flywheel (consumer app, 25M+ users, 1M monthly downloads T1). The signup is not the sale. **Payments-attach is.**

4. **Three competitive battles, three different playbooks.** *Booksy* head-to-head SMB (Fresha's 20% marketplace fee beats Booksy's 30% T1). *Vagaro* US multi-vertical (Fresha's pricing reveal is cleaner). *Boulevard / Mindbody* upmarket — Fresha is currently weaker here. Pick your move based on which one the prospect names.

5. **The sales org has no sitting CRO/CCO.** Two CCOs left in 24 months (Frankcom → Epsilon; Chiaramonti → UpSlide) T3. CEO William Zeqiri is running commercial in publicly-declared "founder mode" T1. Aggressive scaling: NA 34→60+ and UK 25→65+ under new GMs T1.

6. **Inbound is strong; attainment is uneven.** Fresha sits at the **80th percentile of all software orgs on RepVue for inbound lead flow** T4, and quota attainment is reported at ~45% (above the 42% SaaS average) T4. But Glassdoor London AM reviews say "basically zero" — the org-average masks brutal regional variance.

7. **Geography is destiny here. NYC reads materially healthier than London Old Street** on Glassdoor (3.7/5, 100% recommend across 14 reviews vs. London BDM at 2.4/13% T1). If you have a choice of seat, the answer is NYC. Five-day RTO is enforced in London T1; NYC reports one WFH day.

> ▸ THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL FRAME
>
> Fresha is **fintech wrapped in scheduling software**, not a SaaS company that happens to do payments. Internalize this and every other thing in the briefing will make sense — quota construction, ICP, churn math, expansion math, why the AM job exists, why the AI Concierge launch matters.

02 The unicorn moment + scale

8 MIN READ

On **May 21, 2026**, Fresha announced **$80M in growth equity from KKR's Next Generation Technology Growth fund at a valuation north of $1 billion** T2. Total raised to date: ~$285M

[T2] (CB Insights cites $294.4M across 10 rounds — a minor discrepancy that doesn't change the picture [T3]).

What makes this round structurally meaningful, not just a number:

- **First institutional growth round in nearly 5 years.** The last meaningful equity raise was the General Atlantic Series C extension in Dec 2021 at $640M [T2]. Everything between then and now was a $31M J.P. Morgan venture debt facility in Aug 2024 [T1].
- **KKR's Next Gen Tech Growth strategy is the textbook pre-IPO playbook.** Same vehicle behind Lighthouse, Trainline, Coder — they back already-profitable scaling businesses, not bets [T2].
- **Fresha is profitable.** $140M+ revenue run rate, >60% YoY growth, “fully profitable” per Ventureburn at the time of the round [T2].
- **The CFO seat is currently open.** Live Lever posting in London for a “highly experienced and visionary CFO... define Fresha's financial strategy and steer the company's continued global expansion” [T1]. For a company that just took $80M from KKR at unicorn valuation, an open CFO seat is meaningful. *Either an exit happened quietly or they're upgrading for IPO-readiness.*

FUNDING TIMELINE · 2015 → 2026

2015 **Seed** MEVP (Dubai)	2017 **$6M** Target Global · Series A	2019 **$20M** Partech · Series B	Jun 2021 **$100M** General Atlantic · Series C
Dec 2021 **$52.5M** BECO & Lahyani · C-ext · $640M val	Aug 2024 **$31M debt** JPMorgan venture debt	Oct 2024 **Minority** Yuv (AI hair color)	May 21 2026 **$80M @ $1B+** KKR Next Gen Tech Growth · UNICORN

Sources: TechFundingNews, TechCrunch, Partech, BeautyMatter, PRNewswire, Vestbee. All amounts as reported; total cumulative ~$285M.

Founder story (the version that matters)

Fresha was founded as **Shedul** in February 2015 in **Dubai/UAE** by **William Zeqiri** (CEO) and **Nicholas “Nick” Miller** (CPO) [T2]. Zeqiri previously served as VP of Technology at Dubai

Holding; he and Miller had founded a business together back in 2005 T3. The original Shedul pitch was deliberately heretical: *free salon software, forever* — strip out the SaaS subscription that Booksy, Mindbody, and Vagaro all charged, and accumulate global merchant footprint at zero customer-acquisition cost. Monetize later, via embedded payments. It worked.

The company rebranded from **Shedul to Fresha in 2020**, coinciding with its evolution from a scheduling tool into a full marketplace + payments + business-management platform T2. HQ shifted from Dubai to London. (Crunchbase still resolves the company under the legacy `/organization/shedul` slug — a path-discipline note for anyone digging through the data.)

> *"I started Fresha to give beauty and wellness professionals the freedom, technology, and support they need to grow without limits."*
>
> — William Zeqiri, LinkedIn, July 2025 T1

Scale, in context

Numbers that travel together (May 2026 cohort, mostly CEO LinkedIn + KKR round coverage):

140,000+ BUSINESSES	**500,000+** PROFESSIONALS	**35M+** MONTHLY BOOKINGS	**>1B** ANNUAL APPOINTMENTS
$15B+ ANNUAL GMV	**$140M+** REVENUE RUN-RATE	**>60%** YOY GROWTH	**25M+** CONSUMER MARKETPLACE USERS
1M+ MONTHLY APP DOWNLOADS	**757** EMPLOYEES (REPVUE, MAY 2026)	**15** OFFICES GLOBALLY	**120+** COUNTRIES SERVED

How this stacks up against the named competitors:

Platform	GMV	Businesses	Geography	Last valuation
Fresha	$15B+ T1	140K+ T2	120 countries T1	$1B+ (May 2026 KKR) T2

Platform	GMV	Businesses	Geography	Last valuation
Booksy	$10B+ T3	140K+ T3	US, UK, Poland, Brazil T3	Unicorn (2021) T3
Vagaro	Not disclosed	~80K (industry est.) T3	US-dominant T2	$1B (2021 FTV) T2
Mindbody	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	US-dominant T2	$1.9B (Vista 2019 take-private); now ABC Fitness T2
Boulevard	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	US-only T2	~$800M (Jul 2025 Series D) T2

Fresha's GMV is larger than Booksy's. Its global reach (120 countries) is structurally unmatched in this category. The unicorn round legitimizes that scale — anyone who tells the prospect "Fresha is just a free booking tool that might disappear" is reading from a 2024 script.

Headcount trajectory

Fresha is **hiring aggressively, not shedding**. Headcount is up roughly 44% YoY per RepVue (757 as of May 2026; Tracxn shows 742 as of end of Q1 2026) T3 . The company publicly committed in April 2026 to hiring *50 Business Development Executives across the UK by June* T1 , plus new GMs for Mexico and Japan. The Global Head of Talent's public LinkedIn talks about scaling hires across the globe in 2025. **No layoffs.fyi entry. No public workforce reduction signal.**

▸ **THE PRE-IPO POSTURE, READ BETWEEN THE LINES**

Profitable. $140M+ run-rate at >60% growth. First growth equity in five years from KKR's pre-IPO vehicle. CFO seat open and actively recruiting. Equity already appearing on secondary platforms (EquityZen) T4 . No formal S-1 filing has been announced. The profile fits a pre-IPO posture; it is not the same as "IPO is imminent." Treat it as a 18-30 month window in which the company is assembling the org structure of a public-ready business — which has real implications for hiring posture, comp structure, and equity story (see section 09).

03 The model — and why it's not normal SaaS

12 MIN READ · LOAD-BEARING

This is the section that earns its keep. Internalize it and every quota construction, every objection handle, every customer-success cross-sell motion will make sense.

The three-layer model (current state, 2026)

FRESHA REVENUE MODEL · THREE LAYERS

LAYER A · SOFTWARE

Subscription

$14.95–19.95

Per team member / month (Team plan) or solo flat (Independent). **NEW since March 2025** — previously free.

LAYER B · FINTECH

Payments take-rate

2.29–2.79%

US: 2.29% + $0.20 in-person · 2.79% + $0.20 online · 3.30% + $0.20 manual. UK: ~1.2% + 20p (thinner — regulated interchange).

LAYER C · MARKETPLACE

New-client commission

20% / $6 min

One-time fee on first booking value for marketplace-acquired clients only. **0% on returning clients. 0% on direct-link bookings.**

→ Subscription floor + transactional take + per-location add-ons (AI Concierge $99.95, Loyalty $59.95, Data Connector $295) ←

Source: fresha.com/pricing scraped 2026-05-29 `T1` *. Derived blended take-rate ≈ 0.93% ($140M / $15B GMV).*

How the model got here

From **2015 through early 2025**, Fresha was the cheapest software in the salon-SaaS market — free. The bookable calendar, POS, client CRM, team management, and reporting all cost zero. Fresha monetized exclusively through payments processing (Fresha Pay, on Adyen rails) and the 20% marketplace introduction fee on consumer-app-acquired new clients `T1` . The strategic logic: salon software was a thousand-vendor market with no dominant incumbent; SMBs hated paying for SaaS; remove the friction at signup and accumulate footprint at zero CAC; monetize the high-margin layer (payments) once the operator was locked into the calendar.

It worked. 140K+ businesses, 500K+ pros, $15B GMV.

Then, in **March 2025**, Fresha broke the "100% free forever" promise `T1` . Subscription went mandatory at $14.95/team member or $19.95 solo. Operators were not quiet about it.

> *"Fresha has been holding our funds... The subscription fees are now based on the number of team members, and on top of that, they're charging extra for text message services. If that wasn't enough, they're now taking a ridiculous 20% commission on new client bookings."*
>
> — Apple App Store 1-star review, March 2025 `T5`

> *"Fee here, fee there, fees everywhere! Why are we paying a monthly fee to STILL have to pay for text reminders once we surpass 100? STILL have a 20% fee for clients through Fresha marketplace while also now giving you money monthly?"*
>
> — Apple App Store 1-star review, November 2025 `T5`

This wasn't a quiet rollout. Reddit's `r/smallbusiness` ran threads with titles like "Fresha app new charges March 2025"; Instagram salon-owner accounts produced reels with titles like "What happened to '100% subscription-free'?" (`@madewithJENA`) `T5` . A Substack writer in May 2026 framed it as a "mass exodus" into Square Appointments, Acuity, Goldie, and Koalendar `T5` . There is no class-action lawsuit (verified — the classaction.org hits are for an unrelated cosmetics brand), and the company kept growing, but *the wound is still open* and you will hit it on calls.

▸ WALK-IN IMPLICATION

If the prospect is a UK or US salon, there's a meaningful probability they're either paying the new $14.95/$19.95 plus 20% new-client commission, or they've heard the chatter. **The empathy bridge — "yes, the pricing change last year was rough, and here's what Fresha gives you for it now" — beats denial every time.** Operators respect honesty about price.

Current pricing surface (May 2026, full)

Scraped directly from `fresha.com/pricing` on 2026-05-29 T1:

Module / Tier	What you get	Price
Independent plan	Single calendar column · 100 free SMS · 50 free marketing emails · email/chat support	**$19.95 / month**
Team plan	Multi-column calendar · per-member allowances · phone/chat/email support	**$14.95 / team member / month**
Enterprise	20+ team members · custom rates	Contact sales
Marketplace — new client	20% one-time commission on first booking value	20% / $6 floor
Marketplace — returning clients	No fee, ever	**Free**
Direct / Google / Meta booking links	Routed via your own channels	**Free**
Online payments (US)	Card-not-present	2.79% + $0.20
In-person payments (US)	Card-present + Tap to Pay (+$0.10 auth)	2.29% + $0.20
Manual card entry (US)	Keyed-in	3.30% + $0.20
Payments (UK, blended)	Per third-party reports	~1.2% + 20p T5

Module / Tier	What you get	Price
Terminal hardware	Fresha-branded reader	$139 one-time
AI Concierge	Call & message answering · 200 min + 500 msg included	$99.95 / location / mo
Client Loyalty	Rewards / offers engine	$59.95 / location / mo
Google Rating Boost	Review-prompt automation	$14.95 / location / mo
Team Connect	Internal team chat / collab	$2.95 / team member / mo
Insights	Enhanced reporting	$9.95 / bookable team member / mo
Data Connector	Export to external BI	$295 / location / mo
Premium phone support (Independent)	Phone, chat, email	$14.95 / mo

Payments economics, head to head

Fresha's published US in-person rate of **2.29% + $0.20** sits in the middle of the salon-SaaS pack — meaningfully below Stripe's 2.9% + $0.30, slightly above Square Appointments' 2.6% + $0.10, roughly comparable to Booksy's 2.49% + $0.10 in-person T1. The structure is fixed-rate ("blended") — no interchange-plus option, no volume schedule, no monthly minimum, no PCI fee. Fresha is not the merchant acquirer; it sits on top of Adyen and earns the take-rate margin.

The UK rate is materially lower — independently reported at **~1.2% + 20p** blended across Visa/Mastercard/Amex T5. The UK margin is thinner because (a) UK debit interchange is capped at 0.2% / credit at 0.3% by regulation, and (b) competitive pressure from Stripe (1.5% + 20p) and Booksy UK (1.29% + 20p). *This geographic gap is structural, not promotional* — it shows up in the unit economics of every Fresha customer outside the US.

The no-show mechanism (why payments-attach is the conversion event)

Fresha's no-show and deposit feature lives **behind Fresha Pay** — it's the single biggest reason an SMB owner enables payments through Fresha rather than keeping a separate POS. The mechanic: the business sets a deposit (fixed amount or % of service value) or a card-on-file authorization that gets charged automatically if the client no-shows or cancels inside the cancellation window T1 . The card capture happens at booking time through the marketplace flow — frictionless for the consumer.

In beauty/wellness, no-shows commonly run 10–20% of bookings, and a single no-show on a $120 color service is the entire week's profit for that chair. **Fresha makes no-show protection a payments-only feature** — you cannot set deposits or charge cancellation fees unless Fresha Pay is enabled. That is the conversion lever from "free booking software user" to "payments customer," and it is the linchpin of the whole model. Without it, Fresha is a free calendar with low monetization. With it, every salon that has been burned by a no-show has a clear reason to flip the switch.

> ▸ THE ACTUAL SALES MOTION
>
> **Lead with no-shows, not with software features.** The signup is not the sale. Payments-attach is the sale. A salesperson who counts free-trial signups as wins is mismeasuring. The actual revenue trigger is enabling Fresha Pay, and the conversation that gets you there is no-show protection — frame the 10–20% no-show rate against the cost of one missed $120 color service. Operators understand that math instantly.

Pricing vs. the named competitors

Platform	Entry	Mid / Team	Premium	Payments	Marketplace
Fresha	$19.95/mo (Indep)	$14.95/mo per team member	Enterprise custom	2.29–2.79% + $0.20	20% / $6 min, new only
Booksy	$29.99/mo flat	+$20/mo per team member	Single SKU	2.49–2.69% + $0.10–0.30	30% first visit (Boost)
Vagaro	$30/mo ($24 promo)	$34–$84/mo (2–7+ calendars)	Custom multi-loc	2.2–3.5% + $0.15–0.19	None; heavy add-ons

Platform	Entry	Mid / Team	Premium	Payments	Marketplace
Mindbody	$99/mo per location (Starter)	Accelerate (custom)	Ultimate (custom)	Not public	Marketplace via app
Boulevard	$140/mo per loc (Essentials, ≤5)	$234/mo (Premier)	$328/mo (Prestige)	Not public	None — pure SaaS
Square Appointments	Free	Plus (custom)	Square Pro $250K+ proc	2.6%–2.9% + $0.10–0.30	None
GlossGenius	$24/mo (Std, annual)	$48/mo (Gold)	$148/mo (Plat)	Flat 2.6%	None

Why this matters for a salesperson — four implications

1. **The signup is not the conversion event — payments-attach is.** A free-trial signup count is a vanity metric. The revenue trigger is enabling Fresha Pay. Lead with no-shows.
2. **Expansion is GMV-driven, not seat-driven.** A salon that grows from $20K to $50K monthly card volume is a 2.5× revenue customer to Fresha without buying any additional seats — the take-rate compounds with the customer's success. *Closer to Shopify than to Salesforce.* Account growth = card-volume growth.
3. **Churn math is different.** If a customer cancels the $14.95 subscription but keeps using Fresha Pay because their card-on-file deposits are wired into the booking flow, partial churn is still revenue-positive. Total churn requires migrating off payments — a much heavier lift than canceling a SaaS subscription. **Logo churn ≠ revenue churn.** CSMs and AMs should prioritize protecting the payments relationship over the seat count.
4. **ICP fit favors mid-volume independent and small-team salons.** $5K–$30K monthly card volume, 1–5 chairs, no entrenched POS, sensitive to no-shows. Above $50K/month, the customer can negotiate interchange-plus elsewhere (defection risk). Below $2K/month, the customer can't absorb the $14.95 subscription and may churn upward to free alternatives.

Where the model breaks (the three failure modes)

High-volume mature salons

$50K+ MONTHLY CARD VOLUME

A 6-chair salon on a Clover/Square interchange-plus contract at 1.9–2.1% has nothing to gain from Fresha Pay at 2.29%+$0.20. They'll use the free calendar and refuse the payments-attach. Since March 2025 the subscription forces a decision: pay $14.95/member or leave.

Operator confusion on marketplace fees

“20% ON MY CLIENTS??”

Reddit, Instagram, and the Medium teardown all surfaced the same confusion: does the 20% apply to *their* clients (it doesn't, if imported correctly) or only to net-new marketplace discoveries (it does)? Salons that don't understand the distinction churn or revolt.

Regulated medspa / clinical

HIPAA + PRESCRIPTION

Pabau and similar clinical platforms own this segment because Fresha doesn't ship consent forms, prescription management, HIPAA-grade clinical notes, or before/after photos linked to patient charts. *Fresha's pricing wins for beauty; its scope loses for clinical.*

▸ DERIVED TAKE-RATE (VERIFY FRAMING)

$140M revenue on $15B GMV ≈ **0.93% blended take-rate**, consistent with a mix of UK (thin) and US (thicker) volume net of processor cost. This is a derived ratio, not a Fresha-published number — flag it as inference if you cite it.

04 The market they own 6 MIN READ

Fresha's reach is broad on two axes — vertical and geographic. Both axes matter when you sit across from a prospect, because the answer to “why Fresha for *my* kind of business” depends on which slice they live in.

The vertical sprawl

Fresha actively markets to these segments per `fresha.com/careers` and the product taxonomy T1 :

Beauty core

THE HISTORICAL HEART

- Hair salons
- Barbershops
- Nail studios
- Lash & brow
- Aesthetic / makeup

Wellness premium

ACTIVE PUSH 2024–2026

- Spas & saunas
- Massage therapy
- **Medspa** (dedicated product line, Jan 2026)
- Tattoo & piercing

Long-tail / new

WHERE THE MODEL GETS THINNER

- Fitness & recovery
- Physical therapy
- Pet grooming
- Tanning studios
- “Health practice” generic

Note: **Fresha does NOT seriously play in fitness studios or mental health** — those are Vagaro's stronghold. Don't try to displace Vagaro in a Pilates studio; you'll lose. Conversely Fresha is investing hard in medspa to take the Boulevard/PatientNow segment, and that is now a viable competitive arena.

The geographic sprawl

15 offices, 120 countries served, primary commercial focus on UK / US / EU / MENA / APAC T1 . Offices: **London (HQ), New York, Orlando, Vancouver, Madrid, Paris, Amsterdam, Warsaw, Sydney, Singapore, Dubai** + a significant engineering / ops hub in **Kosovo** under MD Armend Rexhepi (Zeqiri is Kosovar-origin) T3 .

The geography matters for sales because consumer marketplace and merchant self-serve onboarding is PLG-led everywhere, but field sales / merchant acquisition is sales-led with regional GMs in **UK, France, DACH (hiring), Italy, Iberia, Benelux/Nordics, North America, APAC, MENA**. The April 2026 LinkedIn post by the company tells you where the pressure is: *"WE'RE BUILDING THE HIGHEST PERFORMING COMMERCIAL TEAM IN THE UK — hiring 50 Business Development Executives across the UK by June"* T1 .

ICP center (inferred)

From the marketplace claim (140K+ businesses, ~450–500K stylists, ratio ~3.2 pros per business) and the Fresha Capital cap ($500–$50K loan range, Adyen-data-driven), the center of the ICP is clear:

> ▸ ICP CENTER
>
> **Independent 1–3 location owner-operated salon/spa** doing **$200K–$2M annual revenue**, processing **$100K+ through Fresha Payments**, single-buyer decision-making. Not solo (the model loses below ~$2K/mo card volume). Not enterprise franchise (Fresha is not actively chasing 10+ location chains — the $50K Capital cap signals the heavy customer is still firmly SMB).

The marketplace flywheel

This is what no competitor matches at Fresha's scale:

25M+ CONSUMER MARKETPLACE USERS T1	**4.9 ★** APPLE CONSUMER APP · 50K+ RATERS T1	**4.9 ★** GOOGLE PLAY CONSUMER · 96K RATINGS T1	**1M+** MONTHLY APP DOWNLOADS T1
1 in 4 MARKETPLACE BOOKINGS VIA GOOGLE GEMINI / AI AGENTS (Q4 2025) T1	**Live** IN GOOGLE SEARCH VIA AGENTIC COMMERCE (NOV 2025) T1		

The consumer app is genuinely strong — it is the wedge Fresha can pull when a salon is debating "why pay Fresha 20% on new clients?" The answer: paid-acquisition-equivalent

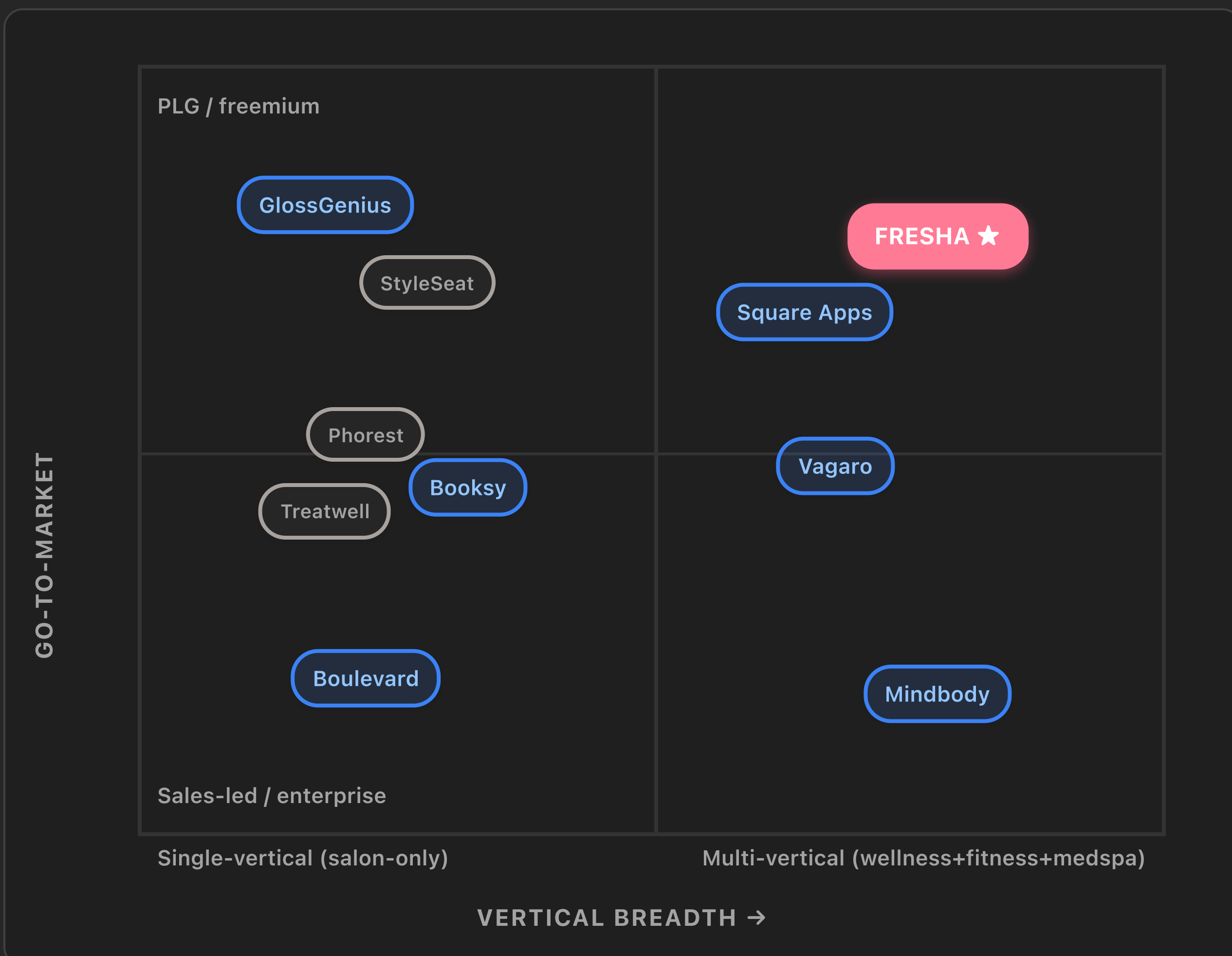
ROAS, frame it against Meta ads, not against zero.

05 The competitive set — three distinct battles

14 MIN READ

Fresha fights three different battles depending on deal shape. Lead with the matrix to understand the geometry, then walk each battle in detail.

POSITIONING MATRIX · GO-TO-MARKET × VERTICAL BREADTH



Pink dot = subject company. Blue = direct competitors. Gray = adjacent / smaller. Source: Thread 3 synthesis from Crunchbase, Capterra, company pricing pages.

What this picture says: the top-right quadrant — PLG + multi-vertical at global scale — is Fresha's near-monopoly. Vagaro is the closest like-for-like but US-dominant and sales-assisted. Booksy sits mid-band, leaning more PLG than Vagaro but historically paid. Boulevard owns sales-led single-vertical premium. Mindbody owns the legacy bottom-right but is structurally distracted post-ABC Fitness acquisition.

Battle 1 — Booksy (head-to-head SMB)

Closest like-for-like, most contested deal type globally.

	Fresha	Booksy
Founded / HQ	2015 Dubai → London T2	2014 Warsaw → Chicago T3
Model	Free→paid (Mar 2025) + Pay + 20% mkt	Always-paid SaaS + Pay + Boost
Entry sub	$19.95/mo or $14.95/team mem	$29.99/mo + $20/team mem
Payments (US in-person)	2.29% + $0.20 T1	2.49–2.69% + $0.10–$0.30 T1
Marketplace fee (new client)	**20% / $6 min** T1	**30% (Boost only, optional)** T1
GMV	$15B+ annualized T1	$10B+ (2024) T3
Businesses	140K+ T2	140K+ T3
Geographic strength	UK, EU, MENA, growing NA	US (especially urban barber + Black-owned), Poland, UK, Brazil, Spain

▸ TALK-TRACK WHEN PROSPECT SAYS “WE'RE EVALUATING BOOKSY”

You're in a like-for-like deal. Lead with:

- **20% vs. 30% marketplace fee** — Fresha is materially cheaper on the customer-acquisition lever.
- **$14.95 vs. $20** per additional team member — Fresha is cheaper for multi-staff salons.
- **Broader vertical coverage** — Fresha plays in medspa, lashes, wellness; Booksy is narrower.

Be honest about where Booksy wins: Booksy's consumer-marketplace brand in US barbershop and Black-owned-business segments is real and may win the customer-acquisition argument. If that's the prospect's segment, don't try to fake your way around it.

Battle 2 — Vagaro (US multi-vertical)

Likely a US multi-service business. Two clean attack vectors.

	Fresha	Vagaro
Founded / HQ	2015 Dubai → London	2009 Pleasanton CA T2
Model	Sub + Pay + 20% mkt	Per-calendar SaaS + Pay + heavy a-la-carte
Entry sub	$19.95–$14.95/team mem	$30/mo (1 calendar) → $84/mo (7+) T1
Real all-in for 3-person salon	~$45/mo + payments + add-ons	**~$487/mo all-in** with add-ons T3
Verticals	Beauty + wellness + medspa	+ fitness + mental health (Fresha doesn't)
International	Native multi-currency, 120 countries	US-dominant; thin UK/CA/AU

▸ TALK-TRACK WHEN PROSPECT SAYS "WE'RE EVALUATING VAGARO"

- **Pricing reveal:** Vagaro's a-la-carte balloons. Show them the all-in monthly comparison; the $24 sticker becomes $487/mo for a 3-person operation when you stack Forms + Branded App + Payroll + MySite + Multi-location.
- **International:** If they have any cross-border plan (or even multi-currency clients), Fresha is the only one with native global ops.

Concede: if they're a fitness studio or mental-health practice, you'll lose. Don't try.

Battle 3 — Boulevard / Mindbody (upmarket)

This is where Fresha is currently *weakest*.

	Boulevard	Mindbody
Founded / HQ	2016 Los Angeles T2	2001; now ABC Fitness portfolio (2024) T2
Recent valuation	~$800M (Jul 2025 Series D, JMI) T2	$1.9B (Vista take-private 2019) T2
Entry sub	$140/mo per loc (Essentials, ≤5 pros) T1	$99/mo per location (Starter) T2
Premium tier	$234 (Premier) → $328 (Prestige) T1	Accelerate / Ultimate (custom $269+) T2
Sweet spot	Premium salon, multi-location, medspa	Yoga / pilates / fitness studio, wellness
Weakness vs. Fresha	Pricey, US-only, no marketplace	Aging UX, ABC distraction, expensive

▸ TALK-TRACKS · UPMARKET

Boulevard prospect: they want premium. Don't try to win on price. Either (a) match their premium positioning with Fresha's Enterprise tier and white-glove onboarding, or (b) qualify out gracefully — Boulevard is genuinely strong in premium salon and medspa, and you'll burn the relationship trying to displace them.

Mindbody prospect: 90% chance they're unhappy with cost or UX. Easy lift. Lead with simplicity and modern UX. Be aware: ABC Fitness ownership has slowed Mindbody's roadmap — your switching narrative is "buy something built this decade."

Tier-C — names to recognize on a call

Platform	Position	Where it threatens Fresha
Square Appointments	Free → custom for $250K+ processors	Bottom of US SMB funnel; existing Square POS customers T1

Platform	Position	Where it threatens Fresha
GlossGenius	$24–$148/mo, flat 2.6%, US-only	Solo independents wanting predictable flat-rate T1
Treatwell	UK/EU marketplace-heavy; €1.2B valuation est T3	UK/France/Italy/Germany urban hubs
Phorest	Dublin-HQ, hair-salon specialist, ~$52.5M rev T3	UK/Ireland/AU/US loyal salon-owner community
StyleSeat	US marketplace + SaaS for individual stylists	Legacy SMB, older product, fading momentum
Schedulicity	Long-tail US scheduler	Limited recent threat

▸ TALK-TRACKS · TIER-C

Square Appointments: Don't try to beat Square on payments — match-and-move-on. Lead with verticalized features (salon marketing, deposits, no-show fees, marketplace exposure).

UK/EU prospect on Treatwell: Stress Fresha's lower take rate and richer SaaS toolset; concede that Treatwell's local consumer brand in some EU cities is sticky.

UK/Ireland on Phorest: Loyal customer base, hard to dislodge. Wait for renewal events or expansion catalysts; don't waste cycles on cold replacements.

Recent strategic moves across the set (12-month context)

- **Booksy:** Acquired Znajdź Gabinet (healthcare vertical, 2024); pivoted to profitability; no recent major fundraise T2 .
- **Vagaro:** Adyen instant-payouts partnership (Aug 2025); “Vantage Report” content push; broadened into mental health T1 .
- **Mindbody:** Acquired by ABC Fitness in 2024 (under Thoma Bravo), joining Trainerize and Glofox; Goldman-led IPO prep paused T3 .
- **Boulevard:** $80M Series D Jul 2025 @ ~$800M led by JMI Equity; cited medspa demand as growth driver T2 .
- **GlossGenius:** Pre-IPO listings active on Forge/EquityZen; $100M ARR (Dec 2024); rumored Series D Jan 2026 per Forge T3 .

06 The product surface

10 MIN READ

You will be selling against a product that has visible strengths and visible flaws. Knowing both — and which ones to lead with — is the difference between a confident demo and an over-promise that ages badly in onboarding.

Module inventory

Module	What it does	Pricing
Online booking + calendar	24/7 self-service · Google/FB/IG/custom links · real-time calendar	Core (subscription since Mar 2025)
Marketplace	Consumer discovery + booking · live in Google Search via Agentic Commerce (Nov 2025)	Free to list · 20% on new clients
Point of Sale (POS)	Tap-to-pay terminals · manual card entry · draft sales (Jun 2025) · inventory + sales tracking	Included; $139 hardware
Payments (Fresha Pay)	Online deposits · in-person card · manual · no-show fee capture · cancellation policy enforcement	2.29%–3.30% + $0.20 (US)
Marketing tools	Email campaigns · SMS blasts · automated reminders · Meta Pixel · GA · AI Blast (early 2026)	100 SMS + 50 email free/mo/member then $0.02/$0.08
Inventory	Product tracking · retail sell-through · online product sales	Included
Team management	Rosters · shifts · commission tracking · cancellation-fee sharing · targets · advanced perms (2026)	Included; Team Connect $2.95/mem
Forms / SOAP notes	Auto/manual consultation forms · treatment notes · visit history · health records (medspa-ready)	Included
Mobile app	“Fresha for business” pro app + “Fresha for customers” consumer app	Free

Module	What it does	Pricing
API / integrations	Limited public footprint — only **Meta for Business** and **Square POS** integrated	—
AI Concierge ★	AI front-desk: answers calls/messages · books · recommends · reschedules — uses live business data	**$99.95/loc/mo (200 min + 500 msg)**
Connect (May 2026)	Client Connect (unified inbox: calls/SMS/WhatsApp/social) + Team Connect (internal chat)	Team Connect $2.95/mem
Client Loyalty	Custom loyalty programs to drive repeat visits	$59.95/loc/mo
Fresha Capital (Feb 2026)	Revenue-based funding · % auto-repayment · Adyen-data-driven	UK/US/AU only · $500–$50K

The AI moment

The lead 2026 product story is **AI Concierge**, launched **May 18, 2026** alongside the KKR round T1 . It's the differentiator vs. Booksy / Vagaro and Fresha shipped a native AI agent ahead of competitors. The pitch: digital front-desk agent that answers calls + messages, books appointments, recommends treatments, handles reschedules, all using real-time business context (services, pricing, team availability).

Adjacent AI shipping cadence:

- **Apr 16, 2026** — Searchable Professional Profiles (pivot from venue-based to stylist-first discovery; repositions vs. Booksy)
- **May 11, 2026** — AI-Powered Intelligent Scheduling with dynamic reassignment
- **May 14, 2026** — Fresha Connect (Client Connect + Team Connect, pitched as “Slack + Intercom native to beauty”)
- **Nov 17, 2025** — Featured in Google's 2025 Agentic Commerce Moment; live availability in Google Search + AI Mode

CEO Zeqiri framed the May 2026 launches as “the most advanced communication ecosystem ever introduced to the beauty and wellness industry.” The KKR funding will go to “international expansion, product development and AI innovation.”

Customer review sentiment — what the operator voice actually says

4.8 ★
CAPTERRA (1,446 REVIEWS) T1

4.8 ★
APPLE APP STORE · PRO (3,500 RATERS) T1

4.5 ★
GOOGLE PLAY · PRO (8.36K REVIEWS) T1

4.9 ★
APPLE · CONSUMER (50K RATERS) T1

4.9 ★
GOOGLE PLAY · CONSUMER (96K) T1

4.2 ★
G2 (3 REVIEWS — NON-SIGNAL) T4

Capterra (4.8 / 1,446) is the real B2B signal. G2 with 3 reviews is statistically meaningless and shouldn't be cited.

Top Capterra praise themes:

- Intuitive daily operations (98% positive) — ease of use, fast navigation
- Highly customizable interface (98% positive) — clean design, personalized layouts
- Streamlined setup (100% positive) — fast onboarding
- Mobile access 4.6/5; appointment scheduling 4.5/5

Top Capterra complaint themes (the operator voice you will hear):

- **Opaque fee structure (68% negative):** "charges and fees are unclear, unexpectedly high" T1
- **Restrictive cancellation policies (58% negative):** "their policy is we need to ask the client to cancel online"
- **Occasional technical glitches (37% negative):** bugs, lag, crashes

The pro-app post-March-2025 reviews are sharp about pricing shift. Recurring 1-star pattern from Apple App Store late 2024 → 2025: "NONEXISTENT CUSTOMER CARE... none of the support tabs work!!! They all take you to a '404 page not found'" T5 and "No customer support available when needed... the app completely crashed and I had no access to that money even though I was charged" T5 .

The integration ceiling

Per GetApp's official integration page, Fresha lists exactly **two** integrations: **Meta for Business** and **Square POS**. Notable absences:

- No native Xero or QuickBooks (accounting via $295/mo Data Connector)
- No Mailchimp / Klaviyo (Fresha forces in-platform marketing)

- No HubSpot, Salesforce, or any CRM
- No Zapier, Make, n8n
- No public developer API surfaced for partners

The Salon Business reviewer (Feb 2026): *"Limited support for integration with other platforms. You're locked into using the Fresha tools."* T2

This tells a clear ICP story: **Fresha is built for the single-location independent operator who doesn't have an accountant, a CRM, or a marketing stack.** Once a business grows enough to need real integrations, the platform fights against them. Frame this honestly with the prospect — if they're multi-location with existing stack, the $295/mo Data Connector is the escape valve, but it's not free.

What to lead with (your top 5 in pitches)

1. **AI Concierge** as the only native AI front-desk agent in beauty (May 2026 launch, $80M KKR backing) — answers calls, books, reschedules using live business data
2. **Consumer marketplace flywheel** — 4.9-star apps with 50K+ Apple raters / 96K+ Google raters · live in Google Search via Agentic Commerce
3. **All-in-one feel** — booking, POS, payments, inventory, forms, marketing, loyalty in one tenant; no Frankenstein stack
4. **Mobile-first execution** — pro app 4.8 Apple / 4.5 Google; the daily experience is genuinely good
5. **Medspa / health-practice ready** — intake forms, treatment notes, visit history natively supported

What to handle gracefully (the three weaknesses)

▸ DON'T PRETEND THESE DON'T EXIST

1. **Fee transparency.** The 20% marketplace take + subscription + per-text/email + processing combo generated visible operator backlash in 2025. Acknowledge it's the cost of the marketplace acquisition channel; quantify ROI in dollars-of-new-client-revenue, not as a fee.
2. **Integration ceiling.** No Xero, QuickBooks, Mailchimp, Klaviyo, HubSpot, Zapier. If a prospect is multi-location with existing accounting/CRM stack, this is real friction. The $295/mo Data Connector is the escape valve — name the cost.

3. **Customer support.** Recurring complaint across Capterra and both app stores. Even five-year customers report unresponsiveness on payment-hold issues. Don't promise white-glove support unless you can verify it for the prospect's geography/tier.

07 The sales motion you're joining

14 MIN READ

This is the section that earns its keep for the day-one reality. The shape of the org, the absence of a CRO, the three motions running at once, the tools, the quota construction, and the honest read on attainment.

The leadership picture — and the visible vacancy

COMMERCIAL ORG STRUCTURE · MAY 2026

FOUNDER & CEO
William Zeqiri
London · running commercial in "Founder Mode"

SITTING CRO / CCO
VACANT
Frankcom → Epsilon · Chiaramonti → UpSlide · no replacement announced

Closest global commercial owner: Taylor Wong, VP Commercial (~48 reports per TheOrg T4 *)*

GM · UK & IRELAND
Tom Humphreys
London · joined Jan 2026 · team 25 → 65+

GM · NORTH AMERICA
Scott O'Brien
NYC · scaling 34 → 60+; field BDM 10 → 32 by Q3

GM · WESTERN EUROPE
Baptiste Donnedieu de Vabres
France

GM · APAC
Kevin Sanchez
Sydney / Singapore

GM · SOUTHERN EUROPE
David Forman

GM · BENELUX/NORDICS
Piet-Hein Kerkhof

T4

T4

HEAD OF SALES · FRANCE
Antoine Monat
ex-Deliveroo

HEAD OF SALES · DACH
OPEN ROLE
Berlin · live Lever posting

Sources: LinkedIn (heyfresha + named profiles) T1 *; TheOrg leadership chart* T4 *; Tom Humphreys LinkedIn post April 2026; Scott O'Brien LinkedIn April 2026; live Lever job postings.*

The CCO vacancy is structurally important. Two consecutive Chief Commercial Officers (Tim Frankcom, now at Epsilon; Alexandra Chiaramonti, now at UpSlide) have departed with no announced replacement. The CEO publicly endorses "Founder Mode" — he is running product *and* commercial directly. The org is currently run through Regional GMs reporting into the CEO.

> *"Some people will call it toxic when you expect them to own outcomes instead of excuses."*
>
> — William Zeqiri, Medium, "When High Standards Hurt Feelings, but Build Greatness," Nov 18, 2025 T1

> *"When I joined Fresha as GM for UK&I in January, we had a team of around 25 and a lot of ambition. Fast forward a few months: we're now over 65..."*
>
> — Tom Humphreys, LinkedIn, April 2026 T1

Country distribution of open commercial roles

Fresha currently has **101 open commercial requisitions out of ~140 total open roles** — Commercial is ~70% of all current hiring T1 .

Country	Open jobs	Office role
United Kingdom	48	HQ; UK&I commercial center
Poland (Warsaw)	9	Engineering / ops hub
North America (US + Canada)	9	Aggressive build-out

Country	Open jobs	Office role
Italy	8	EU commercial
Spain	8	EU commercial (Iberia)
Kosovo (Pristina)	7	SDR / BDR hub (cost-efficient outbound)
Netherlands, Germany	5 each	EU commercial
Australia	4	APAC
France	4	EU commercial
KSA, UAE	3 each	MENA
Malaysia	3	SEA hub

No public posting for CRO/CCO, no Sales Enablement Manager, no RevOps leader. Consistent with the leadership vacuum. UK is roughly 2× NA in headcount today; NA is catching up fast under Scott O'Brien.

Three sales motions running simultaneously

1 · Inbound conversion

PLG FUNNEL · 80TH PERCENTILE FLOW

Free-signup → payments-attach. Fresha is in the **80th percentile of all software orgs on RepVue for "Inbound Lead / Opportunity Flow"** T4 . Highest-leverage motion. The reason quota attainment is "better than industry average."

2 · Outbound field BDM

WALK-INS ARE REAL

Full-cycle BDM/AE converting SMB salons not yet on platform, or on free tier but not on Fresha Payments. NA JD says verbatim: *"Generate new business through outbound (calls, email, walk-ins)"* T1 — the "walk-ins" language confirms physical field motion to salons.

3 · NYC Inside Sales pilot

10-MINUTE SLA, NON-NEGOTIABLE

Newly-built layer that handles inbound speed-to-lead and qualification handoff to senior outbound BDMs. From the JD: *"Respond to all inbound leads within 10 minutes. This is a non-negotiable SLA"* T1 . $80K–$100K OTE.

> *"Respond to all inbound leads within 10 minutes. This is a non-negotiable SLA."*
>
> — Inside Sales Representative JD, NYC, LinkedIn #4382906996 T1

Deal velocity, buyer, ICP, tools

Cadence	High-velocity SMB. Austin AE JD: "Close deals quickly... Consistently exceed monthly targets" T1 . Monthly cadence, not quarterly enterprise. Single-call or two-call closes for solo / small studio.
Buyer	Owner-operator. Single-decision SMB, not committee. Salon, barbershop, spa, nail studio, medspa, fitness/recovery, tattoo, pet groomer, tanning, health practice.
ICP center	Independent 1–3 location, $200K–$2M annual revenue, $100K+ Fresha Pay processing. Marketplace claim is 140K+ businesses · 450K+ stylists = ~3.2 pros/business (small team, not solo).
Lead sources	60–75% inbound (free signup + marketplace SEO + speed-to-lead SLA) · 25–40% outbound BDM-sourced (payments-attach play, not net-new logos) T4 inference
Tech stack	**Salesforce** (NYC IS JD), **HubSpot** (Madrid BDM Team Lead JD), **Outreach**, **LinkedIn Sales Nav**, **Gong** (former CCO held Frontline Mgr cert). *The SF/HubSpot split is suspicious — likely SF in NA, HubSpot in EMEA, or transition in progress. Expect tool inconsistency.*
Lead infrastructure	**Adyen** is the load-bearing partner — embedded payment processor + embedded capital partner (Fresha Capital launched in 7 markets, $5.5M issued by Feb 2026) T1 . Not a reseller channel; it *generates* Fresha's revenue.

Quota mechanics (inferred — verify in offer)

Given the free-software + payments-attach + activated-locations model, quota is almost certainly NOT seat-based ARR. Most likely structure:

Role	Probable quota structure
AE / BDM (acquisition)	**Activated paying locations + payments-attach** within X days of close. Monthly logo + activation cadence.
Account Manager	**GMV processed through Fresha Payments** by managed book + cross-sell of Fresha Capital. AM Glassdoor review confirms *"flogging card machines down the phone"* T1 — payments-hardware attach is a core AM motion.
SDR	Qualified meetings booked + outbound activity volume.

▸ THE RISK SIGNAL YOU NEED TO KNOW

London AM Glassdoor review (Mar 2026): *"Targets completely unachievable, none of the AM team hit close to 100% over a 6+ month period, so don't pay attention to commission potential as you won't be getting it."* T1

Reconciliation: RepVue says ~45% org attainment (above 42% SaaS average). Glassdoor London BDM/AM reviews say effectively zero. Both can be true. The RepVue verified sample (n=14, includes CSM + international) likely skews to roles with healthier attainment. **London new-business attainment is materially lower than the org average suggests.**

The single most important interview question: *"What was your team's quota attainment last 4 quarters by region and role, and how is quota set against payments-attach versus logo count?"* If they dodge, you have your answer.

08 What just happened (last 12 months) 8 MIN READ

The last 12 months reframed Fresha from "scrappy free booking tool" to "KKR-backed AI-powered self-care OS." A clean dated timeline:

AUG 21, 2024

$31M venture debt from J.P. Morgan

Total raised at the time: $185M. Earmarked for ML/AI-powered "robotics" and new market expansion. T1

OCT 22, 2024

Minority equity stake in Yuv (AI hair color)

Not an acquisition — strategic investment to develop AI-powered hair-color tooling. T2

FEB 27, 2025

European expansion: Madrid, Paris, Amsterdam

Deepening “support for local partners” and attracting top talent. Cumulative funding confirmed >$185M. T1

MARCH 1, 2025

Paid tier rollout — “100% free forever” promise ends

Mandatory monthly subscription per staff member, plus “Team Pay” payroll add-on. Salon owners reported being “cornered into agreeing” — opt-out meant losing marketplace visibility, calendar access, and notifications. Reddit, Instagram, Facebook stylist groups erupt. T5

JUN 10, 2025

William Zeqiri keynote at Money 20/20 Amsterdam

Embedded as fintech-adjacent thought leadership. $1.4B monthly transactions disclosed. T1

SEP 30, 2025

UK pricing settles at £14.95/mo universal

“100% subscription-free” framing officially retired. `@madewithJENA` Instagram reel “What happened to '100% subscription-free'?” circulates. T5

NOV 17, 2025

Google 2025 Agentic Commerce Moment partner

Live availability injected into Google Search + AI Mode. 1 in 4 marketplace bookings via Gemini / AI agents reported Q4 2025. T1

NOV 18, 2025

Zeqiri Medium post: “When High Standards Hurt Feelings, but Build Greatness”

CEO publicly defends being called “toxic” — re-brands the criticism as “owning outcomes instead of excuses.” A direct, traceable artifact of leadership posture. T1

JAN 22, 2026

HairCon 5-year Premier Partnership

Event rebranded “HairCon powered by Fresha.” T2

FEB 3, 2026

Adyen embedded capital launch · Fresha Capital

$5.5M issued across 7 markets · revenue-based funding with auto-repayment · $500–$50K range driven by Adyen sales data. T1

APR 16, 2026

Searchable Professional Profiles launch

Pivot from venue-based to individual-stylist-based discovery. Repositions Fresha against Booksy's stylist-first model. T1

APR 24, 2026

1M+ monthly app downloads milestone

Downloads grew 300% since mid-2024. T1

MAY 11, 2026

AI-Powered Intelligent Scheduling launch

Dynamic reassignment. T1

MAY 14, 2026

Fresha Connect launch (Client Connect + Team Connect)

Unified inbox + internal team chat. “Slack + Intercom native to beauty.” T1

MAY 18, 2026

AI Concierge launch

$99.95/location/mo · digital front-desk agent answers calls + messages, books, recommends, reschedules. Lead 2026 product story. T1

MAY 21, 2026

$80M KKR @ $1B+ — UNICORN

First institutional growth equity since Dec 2021. KKR Next Gen Tech Growth fund. Capital earmarked for international expansion and AI feature development. Total raised: $285.8M. T2

Narrative shift, in one line

▸ THEN → NOW

12–18 months ago: “Booking.com of salons.” Fast-growing European booking platform with a “100% subscription-free” hook for SMBs.

Today: “AI-powered global marketplace and operating platform” · “AI Self-Care OS” (Fitt Insider, May 21, 2026) T2 . KKR-backed pre-IPO posture. The 2025 pricing change was the monetization side of this repositioning. The KKR round is the validation.

Walking-in implications

- **Lead with the pricing-change wound.** If the prospect is a UK/US salon or solo stylist, they're either paying the new tier or they've heard the chatter. The empathy bridge is the conversation.

- **The KKR round changes switching calculus.** Fresha is no longer a startup that might disappear; it's a KKR-backed unicorn with $285M in funding. The "they might raise prices" objection is no longer hypothetical — they already did.
- **Fresha is going up-market and into medspa.** If your friend serves higher-end aesthetics, Fresha is actively chasing that segment.
- **Communication is Fresha's new wedge.** Any competitor's pitch needs a credible answer on missed-call handling, client messaging, team chat — Fresha just made these table stakes.
- **No layoffs or scandals to leverage.** Headcount up 44% YoY. Don't pitch on instability — there isn't any.

09 What it's actually like to work there

14 MIN READ · CALIBRATED HONEST

The honest read. The data is fragmented across Glassdoor (overall + filters), RepVue, Indeed, and the CEO's own published writing. The pattern is real and worth knowing before you sign.

The numbers, all at once

Source	Score	N	Recommend	CEO approval
Glassdoor overall	3.0 / 5	251	42%	45%
Glassdoor BDM filter	**2.4 / 5**	16	**13%**	19%
Glassdoor Sales BDM	3.6 / 5	8	55%	55%
Glassdoor Account Manager	**4.5 / 5**	12	**79%**	100%
Glassdoor Partner Success	3.9 / 5	29	74%	72%
Glassdoor NYC location	**3.7 / 5**	14	**100%**	100%

Source	Score	N	Recommend	CEO approval
RepVue (overall)	3.4 / 5 (RepVue Score 79.75)	14 (57% verified)	—	—
Indeed UK	3.0 / 5	8	—	—

All accessed 2026-05-29. The 3.0 overall is materially below the IT-industry Glassdoor average of 3.9 T1 .

Glassdoor category breakdown (overall): Senior Management 2.8 · Work/Life Balance 2.9 · Culture & Values 2.9 · Comp/Benefits 3.1 · Career Opportunities 3.2 · D&I 3.5. The trend is **declining**, not flat — Glassdoor's own FAQ on the BDM page says recommend-to-friend “has decreased by 86% in the past 12 months” for BDM, and overall comp/benefits is down 16% over the last 12 months. Recent reviews (Dec 2025 → Mar 2026) skew sharply negative in London BDM/AM cohorts.

The CEO-toxic conversation (the load-bearing one)

> *“The CEO is one of the most toxic people I got the chance to work with. He loves shouting, calling everyone names and humiliating people. He's constantly comparing himself with Elon Musk or Steve Jobs.”*
>
> — Former Manager, London, Glassdoor, Oct 25, 2021 T1

> *“Dreadful company. Awful CEO... Naive CEO.”*
>
> — Former Sales, London, Glassdoor, Oct 19, 2025 T1

This is a multi-year, multi-reviewer pattern, not a single bad review. **Crucially, the CEO himself addressed it publicly in November 2025.** His Medium post titled “When High Standards Hurt Feelings, but Build Greatness” explicitly defends being called toxic:

> *“Some people will call it toxic when you expect them to own outcomes instead of excuses.”*
>
> — William Zeqiri, Medium, Nov 18, 2025 T1

Read that twice. **The CEO believes the criticism is correct and re-brands it as "high standards."** This is not gossip; it is a direct, durable artifact of leadership posture. If you thrive in that environment (some do), it's not a dealbreaker. If you need autonomy and trust-based management, you have your answer.

Sales-role-specific signals

- **BDM (16 reviews) is the worst-rated role at Fresha.** 2.4 / 5, 13% recommend, comp 1.4 / 5. Most recent BDM reviews (Jan 2026, Dec 2025) are 1-star: "Please, please think twice before applying" and "NO. DON'T DO IT." T1
- **Account Manager (12 reviews) is among the best.** 4.5 / 5, 79% recommend, 100% CEO approval, 4.8 on comp. Small N + global distribution (London, Dubai, Riyadh).
- **Partner Success Manager (29 reviews) is broadly positive.** 3.9 / 5, 74% recommend. Largest sales-adjacent sample.

The cross-role pattern: new-business hunters (BDM/Sales) at entry-level London face the worst conditions. Book-of-business / retention roles (AM, PSM) report meaningfully better experiences. International offices (Dubai, Riyadh, Hong Kong, Singapore, NYC) report better than London HQ.

> *"Targets completely unachievable, none of the AM team hit close to 100% over a 6+ month period, so don't pay attention to commission potential as you won't be getting it. Incessant call & meeting monitoring, with desperate daily 'power hours' everyone hated. Micromanagement hell."*
>
> — Former Associate Account Manager, London, Glassdoor, March 21, 2026 T1

> *"Smart people working together to build a market leading company. High performing and very inclusive team. Product is leagues ahead of the market. Fun social events."*
>
> — Anonymous employee, New York, Glassdoor, May 18, 2026 T1

Both quotes are true. They describe different offices. Regional culture variance is real and material.

Comp picture

Role	Geo	Base	OTE
Sales Executive (entry)	London	£30K	£40K (+£10K variable; accelerators above)
Business Development Manager	London	£35K – £53K	+ commission
Account Manager	London	£43K – £61K	—
Partner Success Manager	London	£36K – £46K	—
Account Manager (Bilingual)	New York	$75K	$100K
Account Manager	New York	—	$100K – $110K OTE
Account Executive	New York	—	$100K – $110K (predicted)
Inside Sales Representative	New York	—	$80K – $100K
Influencer Executive	London	—	£85K+ OTE

For NYC benchmark context, **RepVue's NYC AE median is $105K base / $200K OTE** (May 2026). **Fresha NYC AE OTE at $100–110K is roughly half the NYC SaaS AE median.** Consistent with high-velocity SMB motion (lower deal size, higher volume) — but do not expect "tech AE" comp.

Variable structure: ~75/25 split (£30K base / £10K variable on entry). RepVue scores Incentive Comp Structure at 3.1 (33rd percentile of Software orgs) and Base Comp at 3.5 (41st percentile) — both below median.

▸ **EQUITY STORY — THE MATERIAL RED FLAG**

Multiple direct signals say **commercial team does not receive equity** — only engineering. A PSM review (Nov 2023, NYC) explicitly: *"I wish the commercial teams are given company shares too not just developers."* T1

For a $1B-valuation pre-IPO company, this is material. **Verify the equity story in your offer paperwork before signing.** If you're getting comp from sales role at a pre-IPO unicorn, you need to know whether the “up” is real or theoretical.

Work model

5 days/week in office, mandatory in London. Welcome to the Jungle posting for Sales Executive (London): “5+ days a week in office (Old Street, London)” at The Bower, 207 Old St. T1 NYC review (Jun 2025): “wfh 1 day a week midlevel management cool” — NYC has more flexibility.

The quota attainment paradox

▸ REPVUE SAYS 45%. GLASSDOOR LONDON SAYS ~0. BOTH TRUE.

RepVue: ~45% of Fresha reps hit quota vs. 42% Software industry average / 44% global. RepVue flags this as “High Quota Attainment” T4 .

Glassdoor London BDM/Associate AM: repeatedly claim near-zero attainment.

Reconciliation: RepVue's verified sample (n=14, 57% verified, includes CSM + international) skews to roles with healthier attainment. London new-business BDM attainment is materially lower than the org average suggests.

The single most important offer-letter advice: Take the OTE on the offer letter, then divide it by two. Sales-side reports of ~45% attainment suggest on-target earnings are realistic for roughly half the team; London BDM/AM reviews suggest worse. **Plan finances around base + 50% of variable, not 100% OTE.**

Green flags, red flags

Green flags

- PMF is real (RepVue 76th percentile, 4.1 / 5)
- Inbound lead flow strong (80th percentile)
- Quota attainment ~45% beats SaaS average
- Stage + valuation real ($1B+ KKR)
- AM, PSM, NYC reviews are genuinely positive
- Multiple reviews call product “leagues ahead”

- Base salaries competitive for SMB SaaS in London

Red flags

- CEO leadership style (he confirmed it himself)
- Commercial team appears excluded from equity
- 5-day mandatory RTO in London
- 3-week maternity leave referenced (verify)
- PIP culture used as management tool
- Declining trend Dec 2025–Mar 2026 1-star reviews
- “Many of the positive reviews on here are fake” — internal perception

Calibrated expectation

High-pressure in-office sales floor. Founder-led. Take OTE and divide by two. Geography matters massively. **18–30 month sprint, not a 5-year career bet.** Bank the experience and the comp; don't assume promotion paths are stable. Two CCOs in 24 months. Tenure risk is real.

10 What to ask before you start (and in week 1)

7 MIN READ

Use these in interviews, in the offer-negotiation conversation, and in your first 14 days. The questions are not adversarial — they are the questions any candidate at any pre-IPO company should be able to ask.

Compensation · the actual numbers, not the OTE on the offer letter

Ask: “What was your team's real quota attainment by region and role over the last four quarters? What % of reps hit 80–100%? What % of OTE does the median rep actually earn?”

Ask: “How is quota constructed? What share is payments-attach vs. logo count vs. expansion GMV?”

Ask: “What is the equity grant — exactly — and is it standard for commercial roles? Or is equity engineering-only?” *(Get this in writing in the offer.)*

Why: Sections 03 (quota) + 09 (equity gap) make this load-bearing. If they dodge, you have your answer.

+ Manager + GM situation · who you'll actually report to

+ Comp realism · PIP posture, performance-management culture

+ Geography · seat choice + RTO in writing

+ Product reality · what wins, what loses

+ The equity question, phrased so they can't dodge

The first 90 days — checklist

Things to do in your first 14 days (week 1–2) and first 90 days:

- **Week 1 · Day 1–3:** shadow the inbound queue handoff. Watch the 10-minute SLA in action. Time yourself against it.
- **Week 1 · Day 4–5:** ride along on a walk-in BDM. Yes, literally walking into salons. The motion is real (NA JD says “walk-ins” verbatim).
- **Week 2:** listen to 10 Gong calls — the 5 best-performing AEs and 5 typical AEs. Note the differences in opening, in objection handles, in close attempts.
- **Week 2:** read the last 4 Fresha blog posts. Internalize the AI Concierge pitch (it's the wedge for the next 12 months).
- **Week 2:** read the Capterra top 20 most-recent reviews. You will hear those operator complaints in calls. Pre-load the responses.
- **Day 30:** first quota checkpoint. Verify in writing: was this ramp quota or carrying quota? When does the real quota start?
- **Day 60:** map the 3 competitor objections you hear most — Booksy / Vagaro / Boulevard — and write the 3-sentence response to each. Submit to your manager for feedback.
- **Day 90:** verify quota attainment in your cohort. What % of your peer cohort hit 80–100% of plan in Q1? If you can't answer this question with data, get the data.

▸ THE FRIEND-TO-FRIEND CLOSE

If you take only one thing from this section: **verify the equity story in writing, choose NYC over London if you have the choice, and assume you'll hit 50% of OTE not 100%.** Plan finances on base + half-variable. If the company outperforms, great. If they don't, you're not surprised.

11 How this was built

8 MIN READ · META

The thing you're reading is a one-prompt output. The reason it lands is the infrastructure underneath.

This walkthrough was produced in roughly the time it takes to grab lunch. A single prompt, "build a Fresha walking-in briefing for a new sales hire," kicked off a structured pipeline of orientation, research, synthesis, design, build, and validation. Below is the actual process, named honestly, so you can see what the system is and isn't.

The process, in order

1. **Session orientation**
session-orchestrator reads CONTEXT, loads tiered context, detects engine routing, classifies intent. Output: domain identified (research + content production), engines invoked (Sales Enablement + On-Demand Curriculum).
`~1 min`

2. **Run plan written to disk**
phase-controller classifies operation as scan-then-deep-dive (depth-governor). 5-phase plan persisted to disk for compaction resilience: orient → research → synthesize → design → build → validate.
`~1 min`

3. **7 parallel research subagents dispatched**
Each subagent gets one thread — Company Core, Business Model, Competitive, Sales Org, Product, Recent Moves, Glassdoor. All seven run concurrently using Bright Data scrape, WebFetch, Context7. ~200+ tool calls in parallel.
`~3–4 min wall`

4. **Findings synthesis**
findings-formatter applies tier discipline (T1–T5 credibility), reconciles contradictions (RepVue 45% vs Glassdoor 0% attainment), surfaces unknowns explicitly. Output: 7 structured thread files + cross-cutting synthesis.
`~1 min`

5. **Design doc**
Section architecture written to design.md — 12 sections with line targets, content briefs, diagram specs (the 2x2 matrix, the funding timeline, the org chart, the process flow). Operator review checkpoint.
`~1 min`

6

HTML construction

section-construction skill builds the file incrementally — HPAC design system (light/dark theme, sidebar nav, callouts, tier badges), inline SVG/CSS diagrams, verbatim pull quotes, every claim tier-tagged.

`~10–15 min`

7

Render-validate

Puppeteer screenshots at 1440px and 768px, light + dark themes. Visual verification — does it actually look right when rendered? Mandatory non-negotiable.

`~2 min`

8

Adversarial evaluator

Independent-context subagent receives only the deliverable + scoring criteria. No access to writer's reasoning. Returns scored evaluation — surfaces over-claims, missing citations, structural failures.

`~2 min`

9

Ship

Activity log captures every file operation. Intelligence log captures reusable patterns. CONTEXT.md updated for next session. Sources page compiled. Walkthrough ready.

`~1 min`

The 7 parallel research agents, visualized

PHASE 2 · PARALLEL RESEARCH FANOUT

Agent 1
Company Core
founding · leadership · funding · HQ · positioning

Agent 2
Business Model
pricing · payments · marketplace · take-rates · failure modes

Agent 3
Competitive
Booksy · Vagaro · Boulevard · Mindbody · 2x2 matrix

Agent 4
Sales Org
leadership · GTM · ICP · tools · open roles · quota

Agent 5
Product
modules · pricing · roadmap · reviews · AI Concierge

Agent 6
Recent Moves
12-month timeline · KKR · pricing shift · launches

Agent 7
Glassdoor
Glassdoor · RepVue · Indeed · CEO Medium · comp

↓ Each agent: Bright Data scrapes + WebFetch + Context7 · ~30 tool calls · independent context

findings-formatter · tier-discipline synthesis · contradiction reconciliation · 7 thread files written to disk

All seven agents run concurrently. Wall time ≈ slowest agent (~3–4 min), not sum of agents.

What was sourced

~100+ unique URLs across Tier 1 → Tier 5 credibility:

- **Tier 1 (primary):** fresha.com/pricing (scraped 2026-05-29) · Fresha LinkedIn (/heyfresha) · live Lever job postings (CFO, Head of Sales DACH, AE Austin) · Fresha blog · PRNewswire releases · Money 20/20 keynote · CEO Medium posts
- **Tier 2 (business press):** TechCrunch · TechFundingNews · Sifted · BusinessCloud · Vestbee · BeautyMatter · PRNewswire/BusinessWire press · Crunchbase News · JMI Equity · Partech press
- **Tier 3 (analyst / aggregator):** Crunchbase · CB Insights · Tracxn · Latka · Contrary Research · BusinessModelCanvasTemplate · Wikipedia · RocketReach · Forge Global
- **Tier 4 (org-chart / inferred):** TheOrg leadership chart · LinkedIn cross-referenced
- **Tier 5 (operator forum / social):** Reddit r/smallbusiness · Instagram `@madewithJENA` · Facebook salon-owner groups · Medium `@asbaines` · Apple App Store + Google Play verbatim reviews

Capabilities used (the named system)

Sales Enablement Engine

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Bright Data discipline · credibility-tiered findings · contradiction reconciliation · sources-by-tier accounting · quota / comp / culture frameworks · adversarial evaluator

On-Demand Curriculum Engine

HTML WALKTHROUGH FORMAT

HPAC design language · interactive single-file HTML · sidebar nav + active section · light/dark theme · callout system · inline SVG diagrams · render-validate Puppeteer loop

EngineOS shared layer

GOVERNANCE + SKILLS

phase-controller · session-orchestrator · depth-governor · findings-formatter · section-construction · render-validate · adversarial-evaluator · output-self-test · audit-logging

What this is honest about

▸ THE HONEST VERSION

The system amplifies expertise. It doesn't fabricate it. This walkthrough has weight because the underlying research is properly tier-tagged, the contradictions are surfaced not hidden, and the operator can read the output and recognize what's right and what's bullshit. If you pointed the system at a domain the operator knew nothing about, it would still produce something structurally similar — but the substance would be hollow. **The operator-in-the-loop is load-bearing.** That's the honest version. It also happens to be why this is a moat for the operator, not just a feature of the tool.

What the system *didn't* do

- **Didn't trust training data.** The Fresha numbers are from Bright Data scrapes and WebFetch on 2026-05-29 — not from the model's training cutoff. Every funding round, every Capterra rating, every quote is dated and sourced.
- **Didn't pick one number when sources disagreed.** RepVue 45% vs. Glassdoor 0% attainment — both surfaced, reconciliation explained. $285M vs. $294.4M total raised — both shown, headline chosen.
- **Didn't flatter Fresha.** The CEO-toxic conversation is in the document. The equity-exclusion finding is in the document. The take-OTE-and-divide-by-two advice is in the document. The audience is your friend, not the recruiter.
- **Didn't pretend the operator built every line by hand.** The system did the heavy lifting. The operator did the judgment work — which questions to ask, which sources to trust, which findings to lead with.

One last thing. The 30-minute build is the visible win. The years of compounding infrastructure underneath are the actual story. Most "AI-powered workflows" are a clever prompt and a single output. This is an operating system. The difference is the part that's hard to show in a screenshot. So this section exists to point at it.

99 Sources & methodology REFERENCE

Date stamp: **2026-05-29**. Every hard claim in this walkthrough carries an inline tier badge T1 – T5 indicating credibility. The master tier-grouped source list is below. To verify any claim, find the section the claim is in, find the tier badge, then locate the source in the matching tier block.

TIER 1 — PRIMARY / OFFICIAL

- fresha.com/pricing (US pricing page, scraped 2026-05-29)
- fresha.com/help-center/knowledge-base/billing-and-fees/188-marketplace-new-client-fees
- fresha.com/for-business/features/payments
- fresha.com/blog/Fresha-at-Money-2020 (Money 20/20 keynote, June 2025)
- fresha.com/blog/whats-new and Introducing AI Concierge (May 18, 2026)
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com/company/heyfresha (canonical Fresha company page, 70k followers)
- LinkedIn posts: William Zeqiri (KKR unicorn announcement, AI Concierge launch, 63% YoY 2024 growth, $15B GMV, founding quote)
- LinkedIn post: Tom Humphreys, April 2026 (UK&I 25 → 65 scaling)
- LinkedIn post: Scott O'Brien, April 2026 (7 new NYC hires)
- Fresha LinkedIn April 2026 post: 50 BDEs UK by June
- Live Lever jobs: CFO London · Head of Sales DACH Berlin · AE Austin · Inside Sales NYC #4382906996 · Business Development Team Lead Madrid · SDR Pristina
- William Zeqiri Medium: "Founder Mode: The Secret Sauce Behind Innovation" (Oct 2025)
- William Zeqiri Medium: "When High Standards Hurt Feelings, but Build Greatness" (Nov 18, 2025)
- PRNewswire releases: JPMorgan $31M debt (Aug 21, 2024) · European expansion (Feb 27, 2025) · Q4 2025 metrics with "1 in 4 bookings via AI agents" (Feb 23, 2026) · long-term events partnerships (Apr 7, 2026) · Searchable Pro Profiles (Apr 16, 2026) · 1M+ monthly downloads (Apr 24, 2026) · AI Intelligent Scheduling (May 11, 2026)
- BusinessWire: Fresha Connect + AI Concierge (May 19, 2026) · General Atlantic $100M Series C (June 11, 2021)
- Glassdoor Fresha overall + BDM filter + Account Manager filter + NYC location filter + London salaries
- Apple App Store + Google Play scrapes (Bright Data, May 29, 2026) — Fresha for business + Fresha for customers
- Capterra Fresha listing (4.8 / 1,446 reviews)
- Welcome to the Jungle Sales Executive London (£30k/£40k OTE, 5-day RTO at The Bower)
- RepVue Fresha (overall 79.75 RepVue Score, PMF 76th pct, inbound 80th pct, 45% attainment)
- biz.booksy.com/en-us/pricing (Booksy US pricing, scraped May 2026)
- vagaro.com/pro/pricing · joinblvd.com/pricing · mindbodyonline.com/business/pricing · glossgenius.com/pricing · squareup.com/us/en/appointments/pricing

TIER 2 — BUSINESS PRESS / COMPANY-SIDE PR

- TechCrunch (May 21, 2026): "Booking platform Fresha announces $80M investment, unicorn valuation"
- TechFundingNews: "Beauty tech's quiet giant just became a unicorn" (KKR round, $140M+ run-rate, >60% YoY)
- Ventureburn: Fresha $80M KKR / $1B coverage
- BusinessCloud: "Fresha hits unicorn status after £60m raise"
- Vestbee (May 25, 2026): unicorn round confirmation + office footprint detail
- BeBeez: KKR coverage
- Fitt Insider: "Fresha's Self-Care OS" framing (May 21, 2026)
- RetailTech Innovation Hub: KKR coverage
- Sifted: KKR round coverage
- Crunchbase News: Boulevard Series D (Jul 2025); GlossGenius coverage

- JMI Equity press: Boulevard Series D $80M @ ~$800M
- FTV Capital: Vagaro $1B valuation (2021)
- Partech press: Series C extension to $152.5M @ $640M (Dec 2021)
- BeautyMatter: Fresha $52.5M Dec 2021 round
- MEVP press: partial exit at Series C with 39x cash-on-cash return
- UK Tech News: JPMorgan venture debt 2024
- PRNewswire AE: Bookwell acquisition (Feb 2022)
- BusinessWire: General Atlantic $100M Series C 2021
- Pabau (April 2026): Fresha pricing teardown
- Adyen press: Fresha embedded finance + Capital launch (Feb 3, 2026); Adyen × Fresha American Express case study (Apr 29, 2024)
- Yahoo Finance: HairCon 5-year Premier Partnership (Jan 22, 2026)
- Storyboard18 / TrendHunter / 01net.it: Fresha Connect + AI Concierge coverage (May 2026)
- Diginomica (Sept 10, 2025): Fresha AI strategy profile
- Insider Fitt: Mindbody IPO prep 2024
- GlobalCosmeticsNews: Boulevard Series D medspa framing
- SlotCut (April 2026): Booksy pricing teardown — 30% new-client commission
- Goodcall: Mindbody vs. Vagaro pricing comparison
- GlossGenius blog: Booksy + Vagaro pricing cross-confirmation
- The Salon Business (Feb 26, 2026): Fresha review
- Creative Head Magazine: Fresha AI launch coverage
- Substack @mihais7 (May 26, 2026): pricing-change deep dive

TIER 3 — ANALYST / AGGREGATOR / REFERENCE

- Crunchbase: crunchbase.com/organization/shedul (canonical entry, legacy slug)
- CB Insights: $294.4M total over 10 rounds (vs. $285M press)
- Tracxn: 742 employees end of Q1 2026
- Wikipedia: Booksy (origin, model, 2024 scale)
- Contrary Research: GlossGenius breakdown
- Latka: GlossGenius $100M ARR (Dec 2024); Fresha ARR ($43.4M, 2024 — stale)
- BusinessModelCanvasTemplate: Treatwell, Booksy 2024 GMV, Fresha brief history
- RocketReach: Phorest revenue
- FitBudd: Mindbody pricing + ABC Fitness acquisition note
- Forge Global: GlossGenius IPO tracker
- Newswire.ca / PA Media: JPM venture debt 2024
- LinkedIn personal profiles: Zeqiri, Miller, Greeno, Khoury, Iwanow, Campbell, Wong, Culman, Klatt, O'Grady, Rodgers, Monat, O'Brien, Humphreys, Frankcom, Chiaramonti, Rexhepi

TIER 4 — ORG-CHART / INFERRED

- TheOrg: theorg.com/org/shedul-com — used cautiously for leadership chart structure (Taylor Wong VP Commercial; Pawel Iwanow Chief Payments Officer; Leonardo O'Grady Global VP Brand Marketing; regional

GMs)

- EquityZen: secondary platform listings indicating pre-IPO posture
- Inference blocks throughout: ICP center (1–3 location $200K–$2M revenue), quota construction (payments-attach + GMV), lead source split (60–75% inbound), tech stack split (Salesforce NA / HubSpot EMEA likely)

TIER 5 — OPERATOR FORUM / SOCIAL SIGNAL

- Reddit: r/smallbusiness “Fresha app new charges March 2025”; r/AskUK; r/hairstylist; Reddit “Is it legal for Fresha to charge their 20% new client fee”
- Instagram: @madewithJENA “What happened to '100% subscription-free'?” reel (Sep 30, 2025)
- Facebook stylist groups: UK £14.95/mo subscription complaint threads
- Medium @asbaines: “The true cost of Fresha” (Oct 2025) — UK rate of 1.2% + 20p, 3,500% ROI talk-track
- Apple App Store + Google Play verbatim 1-star reviews (Fresha for business app, Nov 2025 + March 2025 cohort)
- TikTok: salon-owner posts on Fresha pricing shift

How to verify any specific claim

1. Find the claim in the section it appears in.
2. Read the tier badge immediately after the claim.
3. Look up the matching tier block above for the source.
4. For T1 (primary) claims, the underlying URL is fresha.com, a live job posting, or a CEO post — direct verification possible.
5. For T5 (operator forum) claims, treat as directional sentiment — they are real signals but the underlying conditions may have shifted.

If a claim in this walkthrough is wrong, it's because a source was stale or misread. The methodology — “research before agreeing,” “trust the evidence over training data,” “every claim carries a tier” — is what gives the rest of the document its weight. The methodology is also what allows you to find and correct any single error without invalidating the whole.

Fresha · A Walking-In Briefing

Built 2026-05-29. Single-file HTML, opens from Finder. CSS custom properties for light/dark theming. All claims tier-tagged T1–T5.

Produced by EngineOS — Sales Enablement Engine (research methodology) + On-Demand Curriculum Engine (HPAC walkthrough format). Approx. 30 minutes wall-time from single prompt to validated output. ~100+ unique source URLs across 5 credibility tiers. Seven parallel research agents using Bright Data + WebFetch + Context7 MCPs.

For a sales hire evaluating Fresha · sales role · 2026-05-29, calibrated honestly, not flattered.